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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Knowledge Paralegal role in A&O Shearman's Global Financial Markets group is the specific role I have been working toward since attending the firm's open day in August 2026. At the private equity and finance sessions that day, I saw how practice groups across a firm contribute to a single financing transaction, including the security structures lenders take over assets such as aircraft and ships. That session prompted me to take a Coursera private equity course covering fund structures, leverage and exit strategies, and later to complete Clifford Chance's real estate finance virtual programme, where I applied security and financing concepts in a transactional context. I followed the interest up because the substance genuinely engaged me, and a knowledge-focused role sitting at the centre of a major finance practice is where I want to develop that interest further.

The knowledge management and research dimension of the role maps closely onto what I have been doing in practice. At BCLP's international arbitration team I drafted procedural histories and procedural orders, maintained structured electronic case files and tracked outstanding actions across a complex investment arbitration in the weeks before a significant deadline. That work required me to follow procedural developments closely and translate them into accurate, usable documents for the team. At Q-Legal I took a data-privacy matter from initial client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, researching UK GDPR obligations, identifying compliance risks and turning detailed statutory material into focused, commercially framed advice. Translating complex legal material into something a reader can act on is a skill I have practised repeatedly, and it is the core of what a knowledge paralegal does.

I am also experienced in the kind of systematic document and information management that knowledge work depends on. At BCLP I maintained matter records in iManage across several competing matters, and at Citizens Advice I manage case files from instruction through to submission, keeping records accurate and meeting deadlines consistently. At Adobe I prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks, which required me to identify what a non-legal audience needed to know and structure the information accordingly.

A&O Shearman's GFM group is specifically where I want to be: a team whose work shapes market practice, and a firm where I already know from speaking with associates on the open day that people discuss their work openly and substantively. This role is the right next step.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva